

Blake Cerecero

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PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Web Developer — Independent Work

January 2026 — Present

- Researched and published on WCAG 2.1 AA conformance testing and on which WCAG version the European Accessibility Act, ADA Title II and III, and Section 508 require.
- Integrated Sanity.io as a headless CMS in the Teleport Atlas project, with visual editing and a publish webhook, allowing live editing of pages without the need for a new deployment.
- Added Playwright and Node test runner regression tests to digitalblake.com, finding 14 case studies missing their CreativeWork JSON-LD, a layout shift from styles missing in the critical CSS, an SVG that dropped the mobile Lighthouse performance score to 57, and two accessibility violations that Lighthouse caught and axe skipped.
- Built the Core WP WordPress starter framework for Full Site Editing block themes. It runs on Docker, so every developer gets the same PHP, NGINX, and MariaDB setup, fixing instances of “well it works on my machine” situations.
- Built the WP Personalization plugin, a personalization layer for WordPress block themes. It works out a visitor's market segment and renders the matching layout, so a SaaS company can show one message to finance and another to healthcare.

Web Developer, promoted to Senior Web Developer — Seismic

February 2022 — July 2025

- Served as internal development lead for the WordPress to Sitecore migration, working with an external agency's developers and designers, and audited 200+ components to decide what to rebuild in Sitecore, migrate as static content, or leave in WordPress behind a reverse proxy set up with IT.
- Stepped in to code when the agency could not deliver all the work, ramped up on Sitecore, TypeScript, GraphQL, and Tailwind under a live deadline, and built several blog components in Sitecore.
- Documented 200+ Advanced Custom Fields components, development standards, analytics, and production workflows for clean handoffs to 3 agency partners, and trained the incoming team of 6.
- Partnered with the security team to identify vulnerabilities, implemented monitoring to detect and block malicious traffic, and introduced automated alerting.
- Led after-hours code deployments and QA for seismic.com with zero downtime from a deployment.

Web Developer — Gray Digital Group (GDG)

January 2014 — February 2022

- Launched 30+ client sites across WordPress, Joomla, Drupal, Sitefinity, and other CMSs, handling each from estimates and wireframes through development and testing.
- Stabilized projects brought in from other agencies, then built on them to deliver enterprise-level security and performance. This included small businesses, hospitals, and law enforcement organizations.
- Built the WP Foundation 6 starter framework to help standardize our WordPress build process between all developers. This saved us an entire day when initializing new projects, and the consistency sped up the time it took to onboard new developers.
- Led client trainings for groups of 1 to 30 on WordPress, Joomla, Drupal, and Sitefinity admin, allowing each team to work independently of the agency, saving them time and money.
- Introduced our team to tools such as SCSS, webpack, ESLint, and PHPCS to improve the quality and performance of our team's deliverables. This led to a consistent 1 to 2 second page load speed improvement and fewer logged PHP warnings.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Content Management Systems:	WordPress, Sanity, Sitecore, Joomla, Drupal, Sitefinity
Programming Technologies:	PHP, JavaScript, React, Next.js, TypeScript, Tailwind, SCSS, CSS, HTML
Design Software:	Figma, Adobe CC Photoshop/Illustrator
Development Software:	Docker, Git, webpack, pnpm, Composer, WP-CLI, ACF
Accessibility and QA:	WCAG 2.1 AA, axe, Lighthouse, HTMLProofer, Snyk, Playwright

PROJECTS

Seismic

digitalblake.com/case-studies/seismic/

- **Two 1,000-page rebuilds** of seismic.com, a WordPress to WordPress rebuild in 2022 that occurred in 4 phases and a rebuild in Sitecore in 2025, keeping the site live through each cutover.
- **50% increase** in site visitors after the 2022 relaunch.
- **33% faster page loads** on the 2022 rebuild, from ~3s to ~2s, then ~1 to 2s after the move to Sitecore.
- Served as QA triage lead across a cross-functional team of 20+ during a high-pressure rebrand sprint.
- Migrated seismic.com from TranslatePress to WPML for multilingual support and trained 3 agency content producers and the French and German page content editors on the new workflow.

Teleport Atlas (coding challenge)

teleport-atlas.vercel.app

- **In ~12 hours**, built Teleport's Atlas product landing page from a Figma spec in Next.js (App Router), going from nothing to a working page with Canvas product animations.
- **100 Lighthouse score** in all four categories on mobile, with zero axe WCAG 2.1 AA issues.
- **62% page weight reduction** from 2.5MB to ~950KB, including roughly an 89% drop in the font payload from subsetting with fonttools and Brotli.
- Secured the build and supply chain with SHA-pinned GitHub Actions, a pnpm 7-day release-age gate and allowlist against a frozen lockfile, and escaped JSON-LD data.

Republic Ranches — GDG Client

digitalblake.com/case-studies/republic-ranches/

- **60% reduction** in image library size from 20GB to 8GB by automating WebP conversion and compression on all uploads.
- **10% more property tour bookings** after cutting page loads from ~3 to 5s down to ~1 to 2s.
- Integrated the Google Maps JavaScript API to build an interactive property map for filtering and searching.
- Added real estate schema markup on property detail pages for greater search engine relevance.

Exit Intent Popup Plugin

github.com/Blake-C/wp-exit-intent-popups

- Built a WordPress plugin for exit-intent and timed popups with A/B testing, GA4 impression tracking, and a per-popup conversion dashboard with CSV export.
- Implemented exit-intent detection for both desktop (cursor exit via mouseleave) and mobile (scroll-reversal trigger), with six configurable position modes including cursor-relative modal placement.
- Built the frontend in vanilla JavaScript with WCAG 2.1 AA conformance: ARIA dialog attributes, keyboard focus trap, ESC key support, and reduced-motion animation fallback.